NAVEEN MAHASEN WEERASINGHE

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EDUCATION

Master of Economic Analysis **February 2026 - July 2027 (Expected)**
The University of Sydney

Thesis Supervisor: Dr. Won-Ki Seo
Thesis Title proposed: Functional Spillover Surfaces in Sovereign Yield Curves: A Hilbert Space Approach
Weighted Average: 80% (79.8%)
Relevant Coursework: *Econometric Applications, Microeconomic Analysis, Macroeconomic Analysis, Mathematical Methods of Econ Analysis*

Bachelor of Business & Commerce, Major in Econometrics **July 2021 - July 2024**
Monash University, Malaysia

Overall GPA: 3.54/4.0
Overall Weighted Average: 83.125%

Relevant Coursework: *Applied time series econometrics, Applied econometric methods, Financial Econometrics, Macroeconomic policy, Managerial economics, Time series forecasting, Economics of Money and Banking, Microeconomics, Macroeconomics*

RESEARCH AND WORK EXPERIENCE

The University of Sydney July 2026 - Present
Casual Academic (Tutor), School of Economics *Camperdown, Australia*

- Selected as a Casual Academic within the School of Economics to deliver undergraduate tutorials for *ECMT2160: Econometric Analysis*.
- Communicate complex quantitative concepts in econometrics and statistics to diverse audiences, transforming technical material into clear and accessible insights.
- Develop students' analytical reasoning and data-driven decision-making through structured problem-solving and empirical economic analysis.
- Lead tutorial discussions, provide academic mentoring, and foster an engaging learning environment that promotes critical thinking and effective communication.

Institute for Democracy and Economic affairs (IDEAS) May 2026 - Present
Research Assistant *Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia*

- Conducted end-to-end quantitative analysis of a nationwide Malaysian education survey using **R**, managing data cleaning, harmonisation, feature engineering, and exploratory analysis across TVET and non-TVET institutions.
- Estimated multivariate **logistic regression models** with average marginal effects to quantify how educational pathways, academic performance, demographic characteristics, and parental socioeconomic background influence agricultural career aspirations and employment preferences.
- Designed and deployed an interactive **R Shiny dashboard** enabling policymakers to explore school-level outcomes, demographic differences, and agriculture perception indicators through dynamic visualisations and automated reporting.

· Built reproducible statistical pipelines using `tidyverse`, `modelsummary`, `marginaleffects`, `Shiny`, `plotly`, and `DT`, producing publication-quality figures, regression tables, and policy reports from raw survey data.

Verité Research January 2025 - January 2026
Data Analyst *Colombo, Sri Lanka*

· Built and optimized econometric forecasting models to predict macroeconomic and financial trends using R.
· Leading quantitative research initiatives including survey data analysis of public perception while presenting results to key stakeholders including government officials and non-profit organizations.
· Currently pursuing research on tobacco pricing strategies in Sri Lanka to help increase government revenue while balancing affordability.
· Created shiny dashboards in R to allow to understand better insights on survey and election data. The dashboards allow for both descriptive and inferential statistics in built with linear and logistic regressions.
· Data analysis and insights for a perception survey study. Including data cleaning, vizualizations and dashboard building for insights. Includes both descriptive and predictive analysis using logistic regressions. Further developed a scoring system to measure the public perception in inclusivity, equity and accountability on public institution services.

Verité Research August 2024 - December 2024
Junior Data Analyst *Colombo, Sri Lanka*

· Building econometric and financial models to forecast financial and macroeconomic variables.
· Developed the Manifesto Comparer for Manthri.lk website for the first time in Sri Lanka bridging the gap between the presidential candidates and the general public.
· Developed and maintained the platform to visualize live presidential and general election results in Manthri.lk where the webpage was visited by around 500,000 users in 24 hours. The general election 2024 visualizations are mainly coded in JavaScript using chart.js.
· Automated web scraping using python to scrape data from websites and update an excel sheet at a specific time every day.
· Currently conducting research on tobacco pricing strategies in Sri Lanka to help increase government revenue while balancing affordability.

Monash University Malaysia December 2023 - July 2024
Research Assistant to Dr. Akram Hasanov *Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia*

· Conducted data collection and data analysis on financial markets.
· Conducted heavy-tail analysis on financial data, specifically crypto currency data dividing it into dirty and clean crypto currency according to energy use.
· Conducted a research on heavy-tailness for both clean and dirty cryptocurrency using financial econometric methods. The information can determine the ability to forecast financial market prices using financial econometric models.

Monash University Malaysia July 2023 - July 2024
Research and Teacher's Assistant to Dr. Mohammad Sharif Karimi *Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia*

· Provided assistance on data collection and data analysis for macroeconomic datasets.
· Provided econometrics students with assistance on the the subject matter and understanding theory.
· Provided assistance on R coding and data visualisation for forecasting exports and imports in Korea along with co-authoring several working papers.
· Modified and created R codes for econometric modelling for datasets and economic research especially on topics of renewable energy, sustainability and sustainable investment strategies.

· Teaching assistant for ETW3420: Principles of Forecasting and Applications - Semester 1, 2024

PUBLICATIONS

- Karimi, M. S., Esqueda, O., & Weerasinghe, N. M. (2025). Asymmetric and Time-Varying Connectedness of FinTech with Equities, Bonds, and Cryptocurrencies: A Quantile-on-Quantile Perspective. Risks, 13(12), 246. https://doi.org/10.3390/risks13120246.
- Karimi, M. S., Naysary, B., Weerasinghe, N. M., & Nagaratnam, S. (2025). Green Bonds and Carbon ETFs: An Asymmetric NARDL and wavelet coherence approach. Development and Sustainability in Economics and Finance, 100094.
- Zhang, Z., Karimi, M. S., Weerasinghe, N. M., Bilan, Y., & Shahzad, U. (2024). Interplay between Economic Progress, Carbon Emissions and Energy Prices on Green Energy Adoption: Evidence from USA and Germany in Context of Sustainability. *Renewable Energy*, 121038.

POLICY INSIGHTS

- de Mel, N., Rajakulendran, R. & Weerasinghe, M. (2025). Cigarette Taxation: Stealth Reduction of Cigarette Tax Rates. Verité Research Insight, No. 01; Vol. 13

PAPERS UNDER REVIEW

- Impact of Entrepreneurship Indicators on Tourism Demand Across Low and High Inflation Regimes: A Panel Threshold (Journal: Journal of Hospitality and Tourism Research, SAGE Publications)

HONORS AND AWARDS

Monash High Achiever Award (for continuing students) | **Certificate** October 2023

· High achiever award is awarded to the students who achieves average score of 80% and above from the 8 units completed and fall within the top 1% of the school population.

IMF Fund Challenge 2023, Semi Finalist October 2023

· Participated in the IMF Fund challenge and progressed till the semi finals.

SKILLS

Computer Languages	R, Python, SQL, LaTex
Computer Software	STATA, MATLAB, Eveiws, Microsoft office, Tableau
Languages	Sinhala(Native), English(C1 - 7.5 IELTS), Tamil(Intermediate)
Other Skills	Advanced Econometric Modelling Time series Analysis and Forecasting Quantitative and Qualitative Research

CERTIFICATIONS

IBM Data Analyst professional certificate, Coursera | **Credly** November 2021 - January 2022

· The course included data analysis methods using python and SQL used in most companies for data analysis

Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate, Coursera | **Certification** October 2021 - November 2021

· Similar to the IBM certificate although R was used for data analysis

Certificate in Business Accounting, CIMA(UK) | **Certification** December 2020 - April 2021

· The certificate is in relations with management accounting with the subjects of financial accounting, management accounting, economics and law.

REFEREES

Dr. Mohammad Sharif Karimi

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